

Benefits Overview 2026

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Owner: People Operations

Applies to: All employees working 20 hours a week or more

What Northwind provides

This document summarises every benefit Northwind offers and points to the detailed policy for each. Where this summary and a detailed policy disagree, the detailed policy is correct and you should tell People Operations so this one can be fixed.

Benefits are provided through the entity that employs you. An employee of Northwind Systems Inc has a different medical plan from an employee of Northwind Systems UK Ltd, because the two countries provide healthcare differently. Read the section for your own location.

Eligibility

All employees working 20 hours a week or more are eligible from their first day. There is no waiting period for medical, dental, vision or life cover.

Contractors engaged through an agency are not eligible for Northwind benefits and receive whatever their agency provides. Interns on placements of 12 weeks or more receive medical cover and the wellness allowance, but not retirement contributions.

Enrolment and the 30 day window

You must complete benefits enrolment in Workday within 30 days of your start date. If you miss that window you cannot enrol until the next open enrolment period in November, unless you have a qualifying life event.

A qualifying life event is a marriage, civil partnership, divorce, birth or adoption of a child, death of a dependant, or a partner losing their own coverage. You have 30 days from the event to change your elections, and you will be asked for documentation.

Health cover, United States

Northwind offers three medical plans through a national carrier: a high deductible plan with a health savings account, a preferred provider plan, and a health maintenance plan. Northwind pays 85 percent of the premium for the employee and 70 percent for dependants on all three. Dental and vision cover are separate elections. Northwind pays 100 percent of the employee premium for both, and 50 percent for dependants.

The health savings account attracts a Northwind contribution of 1,200 US dollars a year for an individual and 2,400 for a family, paid in January.

Health cover, United Kingdom

Employees receive private medical insurance through a UK insurer, covering the employee at 100 percent of the premium and dependants at 60 percent. This sits alongside the National Health Service, not instead of it.

The plan includes outpatient cover, mental health support and a virtual GP service. It does not include routine dental or optical treatment; a separate cash plan covers those up to 400 pounds a year.

Health cover, Germany

Employees are enrolled in statutory health insurance (gesetzliche Krankenversicherung) with Northwind paying the employer share as required by law. Employees above the income threshold may choose private insurance instead, and Northwind pays the equivalent employer contribution. Supplementary dental and vision cover is provided through a group policy at no cost to the employee.

Health cover, India

Employees receive group medical insurance covering the employee, spouse, two children and two parents, with a sum insured of 1,000,000 rupees. Northwind pays the full premium. Group personal accident and group term life cover are included.

Retirement

United States: a 401(k) plan with a Northwind match of 100 percent of the first 4 percent of salary you contribute. The match vests immediately. Detail is in the Retirement and Pension Policy (NW-POL-032).

United Kingdom: a workplace pension with Northwind contributing 8 percent of qualifying earnings, whether or not you contribute yourself.

Germany: the statutory pension scheme, plus a company pension (Direktversicherung) to which Northwind contributes 4 percent of salary.

India: the Employees Provident Fund at the statutory rate, plus gratuity as required by law.

Life and income protection

All employees receive life cover of four times annual salary at no cost, and income protection paying 60 percent of salary after 13 weeks of continuous absence. See Life Assurance and Income Protection (NW-POL-033).

Time away

Paid time off, parental leave, sick leave, bereavement leave and unpaid leave are covered by their own policies. Start with the Time Off Policy (NW-POL-010).

Everyday benefits

- Wellness allowance of 600 US dollars a year, or the local equivalent
- Employee Assistance Programme, free and confidential, for you and your household
- Home office allowance of 800 US dollars in your first year and 300 a year after that
- Commuter support where a local scheme exists
- Tuition and certification reimbursement up to 5,000 US dollars a year
- Employee referral bonus of 2,000 US dollars on a successful hire

Changing your elections

Outside open enrolment and qualifying life events, elections are fixed for the plan year. This is a requirement of the tax treatment in most of our locations, not a Northwind rule.

Questions

benefits@northwind.example for plan questions, or the HR service desk for anything else.

Plan documents and certificates of coverage are in Workday under Benefits.